A Cat's Torment

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Not Rated

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

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by A_Quick_Jot

Summary

Set just before Catra sets Glimmer free. What if instead of prime making Catra part of the hive mind, he punishes and interrogates her for more information on Adora and Eitheria. How does Catra survive being tortured, and will Adora listen when she asked her not to come?

Notes

Just a short first chapter to set the scene for the next. Brand new at writing, and welcome any tips on how to improve my writing, and make it a better reading experience for y'all. Any comment is appreciated.

Alone Again

“Why are you doing this? Are you.. Are you saving me?” Glimmer asks.

“No…Not you Sparkles” Catra says while putting in coordinates. “This is for Adora, even if I told her to stay away, she’d still come for you. That’s… That’s just how she is.”

“What about you? You won’t be safe once Prime knows…” Glimmer says anxiously.
“I don’t care! What really matters is..” Loud banging interrupts from the doors, and clones can be heard just outside. “Adora’s safety is all that matters now.” Catra finishes as she tries to ping Adora’s ship.
“ But Catra…” Glimmer drawls out
“Besides, I've done enough harm already, and… there's no one left that I haven’t hurt.” Catra says while wiping away the start of tears. She looks down and whispers “Come on Adora, talk to me, one last time.” Come on Adora… Catra thinks while watching the pending connection.

“Adora!” Catra says as soon as her transmission is accepted.

“Catra?” comes from a soft reply.

“Hey, I'm happy to hear from you too” Catra breaks a smile then continues “ I'm sending Glimmer to you, you need to be there to get her. I'm not sure where you are, but I can get her close okay?”

“Wha What? What is going on? You have Glimmer? Wha what is happening?” Catra hears from a confused Adora.

“I can’t explain, I wish I had more time..” Catra pleads. The doors bust open as primes goons rush in, headed straight for her.
“Horde prime is ready for you, do not come! ARHH” Catra grunts as the clones pull her away from the controls.”It's a trap, he wants

you!” She elbows a clone off her and yells “You need to stay away! No matter what, don’t come here!” She feels strong hands on her shoulder and gets thrown into the back wall, pain instantly ripping through her head as it bounces off.

“Catra, I don’t understand, how could” Adora’s voice brings her back into focus.
“Just LISTEN” Catra interrupts.“I'm sorry, okay?!” Catra gets up, and fights off a few more clones, maneuvering herself back to the controls. She shouts “For everything! I'm so so sorry Adora…”

Catra finishes the teleport, and watching Glimmer and her shocked eyes vanish.

“CA..” Catra closes the transmission before Adora can finish.

“Aaah! Get off of me” Catra spits while struggling from the onslaught of clones. For every clone she takes down, three more appear. She lands a hefty kick to one, when another clone takes her by surprise, shocking her with a stun staff, the electricity forcing her to her knees. Another clone takes advantage of this and lands a return kick to her back making her prone, smacking her skull to the floor. Blood starts running from her forehead instantly. Dizziness sweeps over her.

“Restrain her!” one of the clones shout.
She looks up to see one of them trying to bind her hands, but before he can finish, she frees a hand, extends her claws, and slashes his face. He grunts loudly in agony.

“Loving the new look” Catra taunts while admiring her handiwork, and laughs while two more clones successfully bind her arms.

“What now brothers?” A clone asks his comrades.
The wounded one, with green ooze seeping from his face replies first. “We bring her to Horde Prime, and watch that grin fall.” He leans down, getting in Catra’s face, “You numbered your days now cat.” and smiles smugly.

Catra narrows her eyes, then takes advantage of the closeness and headbuts the clone with a loud crack.

“AHH!! Feral beast!” He groans while stepping back.
“Enough.” Another clone says while stepping forward. He backhands her, splitting her lip and knocking her out.

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Catra is dragged into Prime's throne room unconscious, and dropped at his feet.

“Horde Prime” a clone announces. Catra stirs once she hears Prime begin to speak.

“How disappointing…” Prime begins. “Bathing yourself in failure and destruction must be hardwired for you.” He steps closer and looks down at her. “Of all the opportunities you have had to succeed, you still manage to… desecrate it.” Prime chuckles before continuing. “It’s remarkable really, how you outdo yourself consistently.” He lets out a sigh, “The question now is… what exactly will we do with you?”

Still focusing on the floor watching her own blood drip from her head to splatter, Catra mutters “ Doesn’t Matter.. ” She starts to force herself up then says “Glimmer is gone. I warned Adora, she won’t come.” Then while making eye contact with Prime “You will lose.”

Primes grin gets replaced with a scowl as he lungs forward grabbing Catra by the throat lifting her off her feet. “HOW DARE YOU?!” Prime growls “You will regret EVER TURNING YOUR BACK ON ME!!!”

“Do..ahh Your… Worst” Catra utters through choking breaths. Her hands are still bound, and she hangs helplessly dangling in the air. Both her mismatched eyes becoming the same bloodshot red.

“Oh, I fully intend to..” He tightens his hold watching Catra struggle for air for a few more seconds before dropping her to the floor. Regaining his composure with an easy breath of his own . “Take her in for interrogation, we will see if our dear Catra can teach us anything about their Etheria...”

Catra coughs red on the tile, and watches as prime walks away leaving her with his goons when he turns back and says “Do try to not kill her brothers. We may find a use for her yet. Goodbye for now Catra.”

Catra feels hands lifting her up and dragging her back out. “No! Get off of me you psychos!!!” She tries to break free but all attempts are useless.

“Aahh” Catra grunts as she feels a sharp prick on her neck, followed by the sound of metal being dropped behind her. She feels a darkness coming as she cranes her neck and sees an empty syringe on the floor. Unable to fight it, she eventually stops thrashing and closes her eyes. She hears sounds of controlled doors opening and closing. She feels herself being let down on a cold table, and the last thing she hears before completely going black is the sound of shears cutting through hair.

New Reality

Chapter Summary

First round of questioning from primes followers put Catra into a new reality.

Chapter Notes

Short Chapter to show what violence prime intends for Catra

Catra wakes with a dull throb in her head and her vision blurry. She tries to lift a hand to rub her temple, and realizes something's wrong. Looking down at her hands, finding giant metal cuffs bound to each other with a chain. Also noticing that she isn't in her normal wear either, but stripped to her basic whites. She feels incredibly vulnerable.
Expecting the added cuff weight she now brings a hand to her head to attempt to soothe it. Panic sets in as she touches her head, feeling short, matted hair. "No no no.," she whispers. Desperate for answers, she crawls towards a puddle of water in the corner, hoping for a reflection.
What she sees startles her at first. It was her, but somehow different. Her flowing mane was now a jagged mess, matted with blood. A deep cut marred her forehead, and her lip split open. Catra touches her lip and instantly feels a sharp pain followed by a deep soreness.
Craning her neck to examine the back of her head, finding the same chopped hair, matted over the injury. She must have taken a harder hit than she'd realized. Thinking back to Primes soldiers storming in while saving Glimmer. No, not Sparkles, though I do hope she found Adora. Please let me have done that right. She thinks.

She leans her back to the wall of her cell and takes it in now for the first time. Larger than she would have expected, but who knows what kind of souls Prime has had in here. Maybe what she sees as large and empty, others before her saw as tight and

cramped. The front of the cell has a green forcefield for a door that isn’t translucent like the others she has seen on this ship. The walls are dark and tall. No furniture, just a cold and grey stone floor below her. She sits herself against a wall and closes her eyes thinking of a simpler time.

“Catra! Are you in here? Where are you?” A young 13 year old Adora asks. Adora is holding a med kit and looks anxious. Catra is hiding in the rafters looking down, and watching Adora look for her.

"Go away Adora. I'm fine. I don't need your help," Catra calls.

Adora smiles looking up. "I should have known you'd be up there! Now come down and let me make sure you're okay."

"I don’t need your help." Catra answers.

"Pfft, just let me check, then you can go back to hiding," Adora teases.

"I'M NOT HIDING!" Catra yells.

"Then prove it scaredy cat! It will only take a second." Adora insists sweetly.

"Uh, fine..." Catra mumbles, jumping down to the floor. "See?" she taunts. "Perfectly fine, now you can leave."

"No way!" Adora says. "Sit down and let me see!"

Knowing Adora won’t give up, Catra sits down on the edge of a bed. Adora approaches and examines her head. "Come on, Catra, let me see... Oh," her voice trailing off.

"What?!" Catra panics.

Adora giggles. "Nothing right now, it's just that it's hard to see through all this hair."

"What's wrong with my hair?" Catra snaps.

"Geez, Catra, just relax. I think I see it now. And... yup! Just as I thought, you hit your head in training earlier." Adora takes a cloth from the med kit and pours on disinfectant. "I'm just going to clean it so it doesn't get infected. Hold still."

"OWWW ADORA! THAT BURNS!" Catra shouts.

Adora starts laughing, making Catra stop fussing. "What’s so funny now Adora?"

"I'm laughing because only you would act like the medicine hurts more than falling off the training wall. You didn't even flinch back

there! But now you act like a little medicine is trying to kill you." Adora finishes cleaning the small scrape and puts Catra's hair back in its unruly place.
"Yeah, well..." Catra starts with a snarky tone, but seeing Adora laugh, she stops and breaks a smile. Soon she's laughing along with her.

"Odd you find this amusing…." one of Primes soldiers says, jolting Catra back to reality. He deactivates the force field door and steps inside with brandishing another stun staff in his hand. Two towering, robotic soldiers appear from the entryway behind the clone, and start walking toward Catra.

"Stay away from me!" Catra yells, and finds herself backed into a corner of the cell. Her heart pounding when she feels the wall behind her, and nowhere to run.
"Under orders I'm afraid" the clone replies coldly. The force field door closes behind them, trapping Catra with them. The robots advance, and one reaches out grabbing an arm.

"I said stay away!" Catra hisses, and tries to swipe at them with her free hand. but falls short from the chain binding her wrists.

"As anticipated" The clone says while stepping forward with a menacing grin. He extends the staff, unleashing a surge of electricity, and watches Catra being electrocuted.

"AHHHH" Catra screams, feeling the shock through her body. She falls to the floor unable to control herself.

"I wouldn't try that again if I were you, I'm not sure how much of that your heart can handle." He turns heading out. "Grab her now, something tells me she will be more cooperative now."

Catra feels cold metal arms stand her up, forcing her to face her oppressor. He leans the stun staff against the wall of her prison, and stands in front of her. "I've always enjoyed a more hands on approach anyway." he says smugly. "Now Horde Prime has tasked

us with retrieving any information you may have on the rebellion. Starting with, where did you send the glittery one? He knows you sent her to She-Ra. So our real question is where is She-Ra right now?”

“You are wasting your time.” Catra says. “I know nothing.” She tests her shoulders, seeing how much movement she can get, but is held still by the robots.

“Now listen estranged sister, if you give Horde Prime some actual information. He might find gratitude in that, and you may eat something tonight. As it stands now, you won’t.”

“Well..” Catra starts.
“Yes?” The clone answers with interest, and steps closer.
“They were..” Catra says, baiting the clone closer.
“Go on.” He says and leans down into Catra's face

Catra sees her moment as he leans down and headbutts him with a solid hit. Her vision blurs, but she feels a small victory still escapes her through a cheeky grin. Weirdly she doesn’t hear a reaction from the clone. As her vision comes back she sees the clone has stepped back and is just smiling at her.

“Oh we are going to have fun with you aren't we?” he says, sending a chill through Catra.

Stepping forward, he reveals a knife in one hand and grabs Catra’s already bloody face with his other while eyeing her right ear. “Now research tells me that cat ears are extremely sensitive. Tell me how does this feel?” He takes the knife and shoves it through the center of her right ear, then rips it through splitting it. The cell fills with Catra’s screams. The clone puts the knife below Catra’s jaw, pulling her eyes to his. “Now let's try this again. Where is She-Ra?”

“I… don’t.. know…” Catra pants. Her hearing is limited, one ear sounds like it is underwater, no doubt from the blood pooling inside it, and pouring down the side of her face. Sharp pain

radiates from mangled ear. “Please, I really don’t know.” She begs, hating herself for it.

The clone narrows his eyes. “Perhaps..” Then he takes the knife and slices her left cheek slowly while saying “Perhaps you need more motivation.” He then steps back and faces the wall in thought. Catra lets her face drop toward the floor. And watches blood drop and splatter on the floor from all parts of her face. Tears start to flow and fall, watching it mix with her blood.

Catra feels the robot's grip release, seeing them both walk toward the forcefield door with the clone. “I’ll return soon, with some more motivation for you.” They exit and the forcefield shuts behind them leaving her alone and hurt. She sits down and curls herself in a corner. She fixes her teary eyes on the roof of her cell, counting the cracks until she falls asleep.

A Connection

Chapter Summary

Primes clone pushes for something useful for Prime

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra thinks it has been at least 3 days since the clone with the knife left, judging by the scabbing wounds on her body. Her split lip is dry, cracked and desperate for water. Her forehead and back are covered in a fever induced sweat. She was expecting one, there was no way this cell was clean. The shackles around her wrist have started to rub them raw, making any movement extremely painful.

The quiet seems never ending, and overbearing here in this cell. Catra almost longs for the clone to come back. She leans her body against the wall watching the forcefield door. Green lines of electricity dance and flicker through the barrier. Watching the movement has brought her a small peace. A distraction. Something for her mind to focus on. As she watches on, the lines stop interweaving and straighten out, and a small slit opens at the bottom of the door. Sitting up, she sees a try slide through the small gap into her cell. The force field then returns back to its normal state, the waves of green moving through each other once again.

Not wanting to risk a headrush from standing, she crawls over to the tray to find a small cup of water and a single slice of bread. At least she thinks it is bread, it looks like it, but has a strange gray color. Catra takes her cuffed hands and gently picks up the small cup of water, pulling it to her lips. Before she can take a much needed drink the forcefield comes down and a clone storms in. He kicks her square in the chest with a loud crack, knocking her over and spilling the water to the floor.

“You eat only after complying with Primes demands.” The clone states. Catra gasps on the ground for air, feeling her lungs trying to inflate, but unable to get a full breath. She knows he had cracked a rib, if not broken one.

“Screw you!.” Catra starts. She tries to yell more, but still hasn’t found her breath. Catra coughs and new blood comes out coating her dry lips.

“A shame that your time alone hasn’t taught you any manners.” He says before sending another kick to her stomach. Catra cries out in pain. “Maybe you have had time to reflect and remember something useful for Horde Prime.” The clone says.

The clone begins pacing the cell while Catra takes heavy breaths, her face glued to the floor. “To refresh your memory, in our last visit, I asked you about She-Ra’s whereabouts. To which you claimed you didn’t know.” He glares down at her, then almost forcibly softens his face. “If it were up to me then you’d already be forgotten, left to die down here. However, one does not question Prime’s wisdom.”

“If Prime is so smart, then why is he asking me where Adora is?” Catra bites back.

The clone rushes toward her, placing his boot in the center of her back with a loud crunch. “Insulting Prime will only bring you more suffering.” He adds more weight to his boot until another crack is heard from Catra’s chest. Breaking another rib. Catra screams out in agony, her pain echoing off the cell walls.

He removes his boot from her back, and looks down at Catra’s crumpled form. “Maybe if we share information, you’ll find yourself willing to share as well.” Catra’s pain makes it hard to concentrate on anything he's saying but she manages to glare back up at him.

“Of course you know we were tracking a ship that was directed toward ours, which we now know held She-Ra. Your… efforts

caused a sudden change of direction, and not one that could be predicted. On our side it appears that, instead of the ship returning to the direction from which it came, it chose a new path entirely.”

The clone starts to pace again. "Our question is where would She-Ra go? If not back to her home planet. Surely our glittery guest had told you something. Perhaps a hideout on another planet?”

Catra would laugh if her ribs weren’t on fire, but somehow still manages to smirk back at the clone. “So Adora got away. Good… Prime will never get his dirty hands on her.” Catra says through ragged breaths.

“Prime knows otherwise..” The clone says while coming back and standing over her. “You have only delayed progression." The clone eyes her suspiciously. “ Previously he did question your loyalty to She-Ra, and believed there was more than you let on.”

Catra rolls over and propping herself up by her elbows. The cuffs on her wrists scrape against the floor. “You might as well kill me, I don’t know anything, and even if I did, I'd never give you anything you could use against Adora.” She says facing the floor. Catra then sits herself back up to face the clone, holding her chest as best she can with her chained hands.

The clone just looks down at her with an almost stoic expression, just a hint of a smirk on his face.

“What? Did you just realize this is all a waste of time?” Catra says to him.
“How interesting..” the clone says simply. Catra says nothing in return and looks instead at an empty wall of her cell.

“When we speak of She-Ra, you answer in defense of Adora.” The clone states simply.

“You are dumber than you look.” Catra says stifling another laugh because it hurts too much to breathe. “She-Ra is Adora” she finishes.

“We are aware, however its odd you refer to She-Ra in a lesser form.” The clone says stepping down to her level. “Unless that is you have a personal connection to Adora.” Catra’s eyes blink and open just a little wider under the clones accusation. “However that doesn’t matter, the true question is if Adora has a connection to you.” Catra’s eyes soften and she looks downcast.

“Sorry to disappoint but...” Catra starts. “Adora hates me.” She says more to herself than to the clone.

“How interesting.” The clone says while appearing deep in thought. "Even if you are correct, hate still ties oneself to another.” The clones head then turns up toward the ceiling and back down facing Catra with a wicked smile. His eyes are now glowing a brighter green then previous and speaks with Horde Primes voice. “A connection nonetheless.”

“I think you sufficed enough for a meal now.” He says with his voice returned back to it's original state. The clone snaps his fingers and the shield door goes down. A robot walks in with a new tray carrying a taller cup of water and two pieces of the gray bread. The robotic soldier sets down the tray and walks out. The clone follows shortly behind, lingering at the exit. “I'll return soon, enjoy your dinner.”

As they both leave, the forcefield door closes and becomes the same solid green. She drags herself to the tray, crying with each movement. She drags the tray with herself to lean against the wall. With her already bruising back leaning on the wall, she tries again with the cup of water. Bringing it slowly to her lips, her hands shaking, the chain between them rattling with the movement. She swallows the water greedily while a memory starts to swirl.

“Hey save some for me!” A teenage Adora says while trying to swipe the water canister away from Catra.

“Not my fault you didn’t bring your own!” Catra teases, before handing it over to Adora.

Adora happily takes it and starts drinking. After a much needed drink she says “Um in case you forgot, I DID!! You drank it on the way up here.”

Catra laughs. “Oh did I? Yeah don’t think so, you are probably losing it Adora.”

“Okay yeah whatever. So this is the place you wanted to show me?” Adora asks while walking to the edge of a cliff hovering over the Fright Zone. “OH WOW.” Adora begins.

“I know.” Catra smiles while walking up behind her. “You can see the whole city from here, but can’t hear anybody in it. It’s … kinda peaceful.” Catra says while looking away from Adora.

Adora grabs Catra’s hand softly. “Hey I get it, you don’t have to explain. Thank you for showing me this place.”
“Uh yeah. You’re welcome” Catra stammers. “Next time we come, I'll bring more water.” Catra finishes.

Adora laughs with a smile. “Yeah that’d be super great.”

They sit together watching the city while gossiping about anything and everything, sharing laughs for the rest of the night before heading back home.

Chapter End Notes

> Thanks to everyone leaving Kudos! It keeps me motived to write. The more I write, the more practice I get to become better.

The Transmission

Chapter Summary

Prime tries to use Catra to lure Adora back to the ship.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Horde Prime sits on his throne, a sinister smile on his lips. As the clone that had interrogated Catra enters, Prime motions for him to approach.

"You summoned me Horde Prime?" He asks.
"Indeed." Prime replies. "I wanted to discuss your findings with Catra."
"Of course." The clone responds.

Prime stands and starts walking to his controls below the towering screens. After a few keystrokes he brings up a past image of Adora as She-Ra on Etheria.

"I believe we can use Catra to lure our She-Ra to us. I'm told we still have the ship's transmission data from when Catra made contact?" Prime asks his clone.

"That's correct." The clone confirms. "She didn't have time to erase the transmission history."

"Excellent." Prime says, his voice dripping with anticipation. "Retrieve Catra and bring her here. We are going to send a message to… her Adora." Prime zooms in on the photo of Adora. "Something tells me Adora won't be able to resist."

"Prime, I'm not sure if Catra would willingly cooperate." The clone says hesitantly.
"Oh she won't know we are preparing a transmission." Prime dismisses his clone's concern. "Trust me brother, Just bring her to

me, and I'll handle the rest.” He continues to stare at the image of Adora. A malevolent gleam in his eye.

“Yes Horde Prime.” The clone says and heads out of the throne room.

Catra’s stomach rumbles. The water and bread provided relief for a short time, but has since faded leaving her weak. She knows that when the clone returns, it could be his final visit, if she lives to see him return. With each shallow breath, a sharp pain lances through her chest.

Losing herself in thought, she thinks about the clone’s words about her connection to Adora. Her mind drifts to Adora, hoping she is safe, and far away from here. Those thoughts quickly circle back to herself, and how she is anything but safe here.

“I'm scared Adora.” She whispers to herself. “Not of dying, but what happens to you and your stupid friends when I'm gone.” She stifles a laugh thinking about them all. “I’m so sorry that it’s taken me this long to come around. You have to find a way to stop Prime. If anyone can, it would be you. You always find a way to be the hero.”

She closes her eyes, finally letting the tears spill freely. “I'm so, so sorry Adora.”

She must have fallen asleep for a while after she closed her eyes, because she is startled awake by footsteps outside her cell. She hears the now familiar hum of the force field barrier deactivating, but doesn’t bother look that way. She can see from her peripheral another clone has returned flanked with two robotic soldiers at his sides.

“Stand Catra.” The clone demands. “Horde Prime requires your presence.” This clone seems different from the last. Though all the clones are identical, she thinks this one is a different individual. He doesn’t have the same predatory gaze as the one that left her bloodied.

“Tell him I said thanks for the offer, but I'm preoccupied.” She says sarcastically. She holds up her cuffed hands in a mocking gesture.

“You haven’t a choice.” The clone retorts and nods to one of the robots.

The robot steps forward and grabs Catra's cuffed wrists with a powerful arm. With a quick maneuver and a loud click, the shackles clatter to the floor.

Catra stares in shock and starts to rub her sore wrists. This clone has to be a different one. There’s no way the other one would release her like this.

“Stand Catra, this is the last time I will ask nicely.” The clone says and flaunts a stun staff at his side. The electricity dancing along it’s length.

Catra stands, her hands instinctively cradling her injured chest. She can feel movement where there shouldn’t be when she applies pressure to her ribs. She follows the clone out, and the robotic soldiers trail behind her.

“Where are we going? Why did you free my hands?” Catra asks. “Prime has summoned you, of course.” The clone says striding forward without turning to face her. “As far as your restraints, you are too weak to pose any sort of threat now.”

“Great..” Catra mutters. The clone was right though. Every breath brings a sting of pain. She couldn’t fight now if she wanted to. Lost in thought, she slows her pace. A soldier behind her, puts his robotic arm out and nudges her forward.

“Keep pace Catra, or they will force you too.” The clone calls from up ahead.

Catra forces herself to keep pace with her captors. Her eyes watching the hall ahead of them.

“Wait, you keep calling me Catra..” She says to the clone ahead of her. “None of the other ones do that..”

Soon they approach the doors that lead into Primes throne room. They stop just in front of the doors and the clone not moving to open the doors just yet.

“Thanks for taking off my cuffs Hordak.” Catra whispers, staring at the clone a little more closely.

“You are to meet Prime now, answer his questions, and control yourself. It will bring you less suffering estranged sister.” The clone replies, replacing her name. Soon the doors open and they all walk forward, Catra with a little push from one of the robots. Inside the throne room Prime stands surrounded by more of his clone followers.

Horde Prime sees his follower and Catra entering the room. He waits until Catra is on the platform before pressing a button on the control center. Secretly activating an audio recording.

“Poor Catra, I must say you have seen better days.” Prime taunts. One of the robots forces Catra to her knees, eliciting a groan from her.

“Tell me Catra, how are you enjoying your new accommodations? Are you regretting betraying me and my hospitality?”

Catra pants through heavy breaths looking up at Prime. “Actually.. It might be the only thing I don’t regret.”

Primes smirk fades, and he exchanges a look to a nearby clone silently communicating with him. The clone steps forward toward and extends a staff with a loud click. With a loud smack he strikes Catra in the side. Catra cries out, and falls to her side. Small whimpers escaping her.

Prime nods to another clone, who pulls Catra back to her knees. “Tell me Catra, how would your Adora would feel if she saw you like this.” Prime taunts again.

Catra can’t respond, only heavy strained breaths can be heard from her. Prime nods to the clone with the staff. The clone rears back with the staff and hits Catra again, this time across her back. a loud smack. Catra cries out in pain but manages to stay on her knees this time.

“You will speak when spoken too.” Prime says calmly. “Please Catra, I’m curious. What would Adora do if she saw you like this?” Prime circles Catra studying her. “Beaten, bruised..” Prime pauses his speech and leans down into her space grabbing her face with his hand before finishing. “And broken.” He tosses her face to the side and stands back up, turning his back on her.

“She’d kill you.” Catra whispers.

Prime turns back to her. “What was that?”

With a little more strength she speaks again. “ I said… she’d kill you.” She holds his gaze on the last word.
Satisfied with her answer, Prime smiles. “She is welcome to try.” Prime looks to his clones. “Take her away now brothers. She has overstayed her welcome. Kill her if you wish.”

Prime walks up to the control center and with a quick movement, stops the audio recording. Catra is escorted back out of the throne room, and once she is taken away Prime addresses those who remain. “Was all of that captured?”

“Yes Horde Prime.” comes a quick reply.
“Prepare the transmission. Then be on the watch for their arrival.”

Prime states simply.

“Are you expecting for She-Ra to come?” a clone says while preparing the transmission.

“Best believe brother, once she hears that. She’ll come.” “We will have our She-Ra soon enough.”

Chapter End Notes

> Next chapter will be entirely Adora's point of view. Is there anything yall want to see happen? let me know. loving the feedback and the kudos.

A Promise

Chapter Summary

> Takes place shortly after the episode where Glimmer has been reunited with Adora and Bow for a couple of days now thanks to Catra's efforts. The gang needed to take a detour when Darla's fuel source crystal depleted itself. There they met a trio of siblings also looking for a fuel source. With their combined efforts all of them managed to get enough to power their separate ships. Adora and her friends have boarded Darla and are finally preparing to head back home to Eitheria. We begin this chapter with Adora finds herself hesitating on telling Darla where to go.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Glimmer approaches Adora who is staring at Darla's screens in deep thought. "Something on your mind Adora?" She asks gently.

Some time passes before Adora answers. "I can't just leave her there." Adora confesses, turning to Glimmer. Adora can't just abandon Catra. No matter all the wrong she has done. "I know she hasn't been the nicest to us, and she has tried to kill us." Adora continues to blabber about all the horrible things Catra has done until Glimmer interrupts her.

"Hey, Catra sacrificed herself to save me." Glimmer reminds her. She puts her hands on Adora's shoulders making Adora stop and look at her. "Whatever you need to do, I'm with you."

Bow joins the girls, laying a hand softly on Glimmer. "She did get you back to us, and it would be nice to thank her for that. We are the best friend squad, we can do anything."

"Jewelstar had said that no one stands up to Horde Prime and survives." Adora looks mentally torn.

“I can’t ask both of you to come with me, but I have to try..” Adora looks down at her feet, her voice full of doubt and fear.

Glimmer looks from Bow to Adora. “No way, now that we are all together again, we will figure this out together. We will get Catra back. It’s going to be okay Adora.”

“I guess that’s it then.” Adora nods with determination while walking over to the command center in the ship. “Darla, set course for Prime’s ship.” Adora looks back to her friends. “We are going to need a plan. “Lets rest up now, and form a strategy after..” Adora leaves her friends retreating to her room.

Once her door is closed she relaxes her shoulders and lets her hair down. She sits down on her bed mat, laying back staring at the ceiling of the ship. Memories of her recent conversation with Jewelstar from today haunt her throughout the night. Her mind racing as she repeats what he had said. *If Prime has your friend, then it’s already too late.*

“Hold on Catra.” She whispers. “We’re coming”. Exhausted, Adora finally drifts off to sleep, hoping for a solution to their perilous situation.

Adora is the first one awake, at least she thinks so before she enters the bridge of the ship. Adora hears a commotion of metallic clangs coming from the controls. Little clinks and bangs from beneath, filling the room with echoes. Before she can get closer to inspect it. Entrapta pops out, wrenches in hand.

“Oh! Hi Adora!” Entrapta chirps in her bright and bubbly way.

“Uh Entrapta, what are you doing?” Adora asks flatly.

“Just giving Darla an upgrade.” She says mischievously. “Just promise me you won’t tell Bow.” She replies with a cheeky smile.

“He says I can’t tinker with Darla, but maybe that just means no tinkering when he's awake? Hmm, up to interpretation I guess?” She gives Adora a sly wink and fiddles with her tools.

“Yeah okay, whatever.” Unamused, she can’t afford to be distracted right now. Adora goes back to pacing thinking about potential rescue plans for Catra.

Entrapta sees Adora’s harsh demeanor and frowns. Straightening herself she hides any evidence of tinkering for when Bow wakes up. When Entrapta finishes, she finds and joins Adora sitting in the storage room going through rations. “Whatcha doing Adora?”

Without turning to look, Adora shows a ration bar. “ I don’t know what is in store for us with Hoard Prime, but we will need as much energy as we can muster. Just looking for something that we can eat when they wake up.”

Entrapta notices how unnecessarily tight her grip on the ration bar is, and shifts on her feet. “You know Adora, I'm not good at reading social cues, but it looks like you are pretty tense right now, judging by the unnecessary pressure you are enforcing on that protein bar.”

Adora lets out a huff and relaxes her shoulders. “You could say that. I guess potentially dooming your friends has that effect.” She sits on one of the storage crates, and tosses Entrapta the bar. “Can you tell if that is still edible?.” Changing the subject.

Entrapta catches the bar with her hair, setting it down. She pulls another gadget from seemingly out nowhere. Opening the bar, she breaks it in half, and lets her gadget perform a few scans. Adora watches her while Entrapta makes curious hums and taps away. “Huh.. can’t get a good reading, or perhaps this old thing is losing its connection. Only one other way to find out though!” and takes a bite.

Adora watches her for a moment seeing Entrapta smile and give a thumbs up. “Not quite flavorful, but not deadly either!” Entrapta says through chewing it. “Now the real issue is why you aren’t working…” Entrapta grumbles to her gadget. “Can’t think if you're not connected silly!” She says while petting her handheld.

“What did you say?” Adora had looked away going through more of Mara’s storage while Entrapta was eating, but her last words caught her attention.

“Oh, the ration is fine, not to my tiny liking, but I'm 86 percent sure it won’t kill us.”

“No, not that, but what you said about your little uhh tool?” Adora gestures vaguely to her tool.

“Oh, I think she lost connection with Darla’s software. Darla has a vast knowledge of all things Etiheria, and I was trying to get her reading. Without it, this is just an electronic paperweight.”

“That’s IT!” Adora’s eye light up. “Without Horde Primes connection to his clones, then they will be less of a threat! A potential way out once we get in. You’re a genius Entrapta!”

Adora starts to pace with her hand on her chin. “We just need a way to disconnect him, even for a short time.”

“Ooo electronic espionage and sabotage! Count me in!” Entrapta squeaks with excitement.

“Yeah, let's head back and wait for them. I think we might have a plan now.” Adora sighs.

“And oh, uh thanks Entrapta.”

“For what?” Entrapta asks while tilting her head.

“You didn’t have to come in here, and you know, help me ease up I guess.” Adora shrugs.

Offering a soft smile Entrapta pats her on the shoulder and says nothing as they walk back to the bridge.

“So only 86 percent sure huh?” Adora says skeptically with a laugh.

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Not long after, Bow and Glimmer stumble in, their eyes still etched with sleep. Adora has rations set aside ready for them on a plate and pushes it toward them. “Hey guys, Entrapta and I were talking about plans to destroy Prime’s servers while I confront Prime.”

“Wait what?” Bow asks while rubbing his eyes. “You are just going to hand yourself over?” He looks to Glimmer for her opinion.

“Adora you can’t do that!” Glimmer yells. “You are exactly what he wants!”

“Nothing is for certain yet, since we decide together.” Adora says while putting her hands on both Bow and Glimmer's shoulders. “And Im not turning myself in, more like providing you a distraction for you guys to do damage to the servers and rescue Catra.”

"Why you Adora? This seems too risky." Glimmer persists.

"Because you know where they are keeping prisoners right?" Glimmer nods and Adora then turns to Bow. "And Entrapta will need backup while she hacks into his system." She gives a soft smile to her friends. "That leaves me with the distraction part, I have a plan."

Some time passes as the gang goes over the plan feeling as prepared as they can. Entrapta is putting the finishing touches on their space suits when suddenly Darla alerts them.

"Audio transmission received." Darla announces, and shows a holographic of the audio memo waiting on the go ahead to be played. The gang all exchange nervous looks before settling their eyes on Adora. "Go ahead and play it Darla."

"Poor Catra, I must say you have seen better days." Then Adora hears the unmistakable grunt of Catra. She bawls her fist. ***"Tell me Catra, how are you enjoying your new accommodations? Are you regretting betraying me and my hospitality?"*** Primes voice booms through.

Only painful breaths can be heard, all assume they are Catra's. Glimmer puts her hand to her mouth in shock.

"Actually.. It might be the only thing I don't regret." Catra's beaten voice is low.

"Oh Catra.." Bow adds and holds Glimmer a little closer. Adora can feel her friends looking at her, but her eyes are glued to the floor, held hostage while listening.

More heavy breaths that Adora knows to be Catra's come through before suddenly turning into a loud cry, and almost silent whimpers. Adora pulls blood from how tight her nails are bawled in fist.

"Tell me Catra, how would your Adora would feel if she saw you like this." More sounds of pained breathing followed by the sounds of someone being beat haunt the room.

Glimmer cries and tucks her head into Bow's shoulder.

"You will speak when spoken too. Please Catra, I'm curious. What would Adora think if she saw you like this? Beaten, bruised..and broken." A reply comes from Catra but it is too low to hear.

Adora's tears hit the spot she is staring at on the floor.

"What was that?" Primes voice breaks through again.

After a few groans Catra is heard again. ***"I said... she'd kill you."***

"She is welcome to try." Primes voice is the last thing they hear and the transmission is over.

Adora looks up, tears running down her face, making a silent promise to herself to do exactly what Catra said.

Chapter End Notes

So sorry for the long update. won't happen again.(hopefully lol) I was having a hard time writing how Entrapta and Adora interacted.

The Fall

Chapter Summary

Adora faces Horde Prime and reunites with Catra...

Chapter Notes

Here's another Chapter! This one has multiple POV, which i tried to separate to make it an easier reading.

Thank you for your continued patience.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“Catra… Wake up” A voice jolts Catra from a deep sleep. Disoriented, and exhausted she rubs her eyes, struggling to believe what she sees.. It’s impossible... Catra is dead, or so she thought. Why else would Adora be standing here, in her cell?

“Adora?” Catra whispers, her voice painful and hoarse. “How… did you get in here?”

“Come on, let's take you home.” Adora says, sidestepping Catra’s question. Crouching, she extends her hand to Catra.

“Promise?” Catra pleads, a flicker of hope igniting within her.

“I promise.” Adora assures with a gentle smile. “Let’s go, we don’t have much time.” Adora’s open hand draws closer to Catra.

Catra reaches for Adora’s hand and just when her fingers should brush Adora’s, her own hand passes through to the floor. A

hallucination. A cruel twist of fate. Shattering the last bit of hope Catra has left.

"AHHH!!" Catra screams the vision away and slumps back against the wall. "Still alive then." Catra thinks. After her chat with Prime, they threw her back in here and haven't been back since. Of course the clones made sure to leave her with fresh pain before they left.

"Horde Prime has no use for you anymore." Her tormentor had said. Twisting her arm behind her back, and pressing her against the wall. Catra had screamed as her arm was bent further than it ever should, feeling like it would snap at any time. "You will die in this room, little sister." The clone had said before pushing her arm up more with a loud snap, breaking her arm out of socket.

"Catra focus!" Adora's imaginary voice echoes in the chamber, pulling Catra back from the memory.

"You're not real…" Catra groans, clutching her broken arm, her gaze lingering where the fake Adora had vanished. Of course, there was no one there. Yet, she notices something strange about the cell door. It seemed off…. Weaker. Dimmer. Then suddenly the power surges and for a fleeting second the door disappears before snapping back into place.

"No way…" Hope surges through her, another fragile spark. Catra as she stands and leans on the force field barrier with her good shoulder. "Come on… just one more time." Catra strains against it. The door dims then vanishes again followed by a violent

shuddering of the entire ship. Catra lands hard, but lands outside her prison as the green forcefield goes back up.

With panicked glances up and down the corridor, she doesn't see any guards. Yet. She knows time and strength are against her. There's no way she can hold her own against the clones, and there's no telling when they will notice she escaped. If she is found, there is no way they'd let her live for another attempt. One chance. No choice but to make it count. Pushing herself along, she heads for the hangar with incoming and outgoing ships.

Catra keeps a constant watch and for any clones as she navigates down the corridors. Every now and then, the lights flicker and the ship rattles. Whatever miracle that let her out of the cell was clearly wreaking havoc throughout the rest of the ship.

Escaping the cell had turned out to be the easy part. Now, the real challenge begins. If she could find an unmanned ship, she has no idea if she could even fly it, let alone with one arm. But she has to try.

As she nears the end of one corridor, the sound of approaching footsteps sends her heart racing. Holding her breath she looks for somewhere to hide, ducking behind one of the crescent pillars. "*Please, please, please go the other way*." Catra pleads silently.

The footsteps get closer, and unfortunately get louder as they turn towards her. "*No, No, NO*" Catra screams in her mind. A few more steps they will pass the arch she is hiding behind, no doubt finding her.

“Brothers! We are needed in the server room immediately. There are unwanted disturbances.” The footsteps halt, and she can hear them shuffling. A low displeased growl comes from one of the clones. “Of course ***she*** wouldn’t come alone..”

The footsteps take off in the other direction leaving Catra trembling.

She. The word hangs in the air, chilling Catra to the bone. *No she wouldn’t, I told her to stay away. It can’t be her.”*

Catra peeks out, checking that the coast is clear before trudging on as fast as she can. Another power surge rocks the ship, throwing Catra off balance. She crashes to the ground, a scream escaping her as a jolt of pain shoots up her back.

“AHH” She cuts off her yell by forcing herself to breathe deeply through the pain. Forcing herself back up, she presses along again. Soon she comes across another four way intersection where evidence of a battle occurred..

Two clones lay sprawled on the floor. One is leaning against the wall, and the other face down on the ground. The Clone leaning against the wall has a laser pistol in his open hand. She leans in checking to make sure her earlier outburst didn’t wake him before grabbing the gun. Not wasting anymore time, Catra bolts as fast as her injuries allow back into the flickering corridors.

Reaching the ship bay, she closes and locks the bay doors behind her. Sliding down on the wall after to catch her breath. She can

see multiple ships, most of the same single pilot type. Except now there is a larger ship unlike the rest.

Familiar and not at the same time. First ones tech. "No.. Please don't be Adora, let it be anyone else. Catra makes her way over to one of the smaller single manned fleets. The cockpit is open and escape is within reach. However she just can't shake the ***what if***?

"This could be your only chance. She keeps telling herself while looking back to the larger ship. *I have to know.* Reluctantly she leaves her chance at freedom, going back into the danger of the halls.

The gangs POV.. 1 hour earlier

Adora's jaw clenches as Darla descends into Horde Prime's grasp. Soon she can feel the magnetic pull into the hanger. Darla comes to a calm landing inside the bay, and Adora stands ready to dismount Darla's stairs. At the bottom of the stairs stand a couple of Prime's clones waiting patiently.

"I got his sick message." Adora spits. "Take me to him." She glares.

One clone nods to another group of them, sending some silent order to secure the ship. "I've come alone, but go ahead and check." Adora taunts. The clone avoids Adora's glare until the

other followers come back from the ship some time later, nodding that the ship is indeed empty.

“Welcome She-Ra, Horde Prime has been expecting you.” The clone says finally making eye contact with Adora. Two other clones stand on each side of her motioning for her to start walking.

As soon as the sound of footsteps vanish, Bow, Glimmer, and Entrapta dismount from the underside of the ship. Their spacesuits kept them attached to the hull during their descent. Entrapta lands gracefully while Bow and Glimmer tumble to the floor.

“Everyone okay?” Bow gestures to the other girls while checking himself.

“I think so..” Glimmer says removing her space helmet.

Bow’s face hardens, turning to Glimmer then. “Be careful, no unnecessary risks okay?” He says while cradling Glimmer’s face. “Stay in contact, find Catra, and let's get out of here.” He puts his forehead to glimmer in a quick embrace before turning to Entrapta. “Let's get this done.”

Adora

Adora’s been walking with her clone escorts for at least 15 minutes before her earpiece goes off. “We made it Adora, we are

on the move.” Bow’s voice hums in.

Adora offers a quick and quiet “Be safe.”.

“What was that?” One of the clones questions Adora.

“Where is Catra?” Adora demands.

Adora almost missed it, but the stoic face of the clone shows a smirk before going back to stone faced. “Horde Prime has all the answers you seek, child. You will have the opportunity to ask him yourself soon enough.” *I'm here Catra, please let me not be too late.* Adora thinks to herself. *Please don’t let me be too late.*

Bow & Entrapta

After splitting up with Glimmer, Bow and Entrapta have made quick work of finding what they believe to be the server room. There are a couple of clones inside standing next to monitors with charts and data being displayed on multiple screens. Bow walks in first getting their attention.

“Hello! Would you believe we are the inspectors? I’m afraid that most of this is not in code, so….”

Unamused, a clone reaches out to a monitor with his hand, activating the forcefield door closing and trapping them in. Seeing the turn of events, Bow springs into action sending a few arrows into one of the clones quickly taking him out. The second clone charges forward toward Bow with a snarl. Bow ducks and pulls a speciality electric arrow out, using it like a baton. He hits the clone, tasering and immobilizing him. Entrapta runs to the main monitor, setting down her tool box, beginning her attempt to hack the system.

Bow’s earpiece goes off with Glimmer's voice. “Bow! Entrapta! Are yall okay!”

“Yes.” Bow huffs out. “Had some company, but Entrapta is hacking the system now. Any luck on finding Catra?”

Glimmer

Gimmer has checked multiple rooms. Everything was pristine and unused, not knowing there were worse places to hold prisoners on Prime’s ship.

“No, there's so sign of her here.” Glimmer replies back. “It actually looks like no one has been here.” Glimmer starts to panic, hyperventilating not knowing where to go now.

“Hey” Bow interrupts, his voice calm and steady. “Breathe Glimmer, meet up with us and we all will look for Catra once Entrapta finishes.”

“Okay.” Glimmer replies calmly. She turns around fast to head back to others, but finds two clones have rounded the corner staring at her. Both have laser pistols at their side, one has his pointed right at her. “Back so soon?” one of the clones sneer before charging her.

Ducking behind one of the arches of the hall. she dodges a burst of laser fire. Gimmer can hear the two clones approaching quickly. Catra’s words come back to her from her escape. ***Hit them in the back of the neck. That should take them out.***

Taking a deep breath, she lunges out just as one rounds the corner hitting him in the stomach. The clone doubles over unintentionally giving better access to his neck. Not wasting a second, Glimmer slams her fist down on his neck. He falls to the floor face down unmoving. More shots ring past Glimmer from the

other clone. Glimmer ducks again behind the arch, but not before grabbing the other clone's gun from his side.

A few more shots shoot past the arch down the hall. When the fire stops, Glimmer takes her chance ducking out and returning a single shot back. Her hit lands its mark, hitting the clone square in the chest sending me flying back into the wall, knocking him out.

Wiping her brow, she pushes forward back to the gang full of adrenaline.

Adora

"Here we are." A clone says coming to a halt in front of the massive doors to the throne room. "You will go alone." The clone says as the doors part. Adora marches ahead with as much confidence she can muster.

Walking up the bridge to the platform. Adora sees Horde Prime sitting in his throne surrounded by clones tending to him, and a network of tubes feeding into his body. Prime turns in his chair toward her then offers a cruel smile. "Ah Adora, forgive my unseemly state, it is a tedious task, but a necessary one to maintain this vessel. A procedure I must perform every so often."

Bawling her fist, and furrowing her brows, Adora glares back. "This is how it's going to go, we're going to make a deal. You will give Catra back to me, then you will let us leave. Free and clear. "

Horde Prime tilts his head, an inquisitive and amused look on his lips. “And why would I consider such a proposition?”

“I have something you want.” Adora counters. “The heart of Etheria. Only She-Ra can activate it.” She puts her hand on her chest, emphasizing her power. “Refuse, and I’ll use it to destroy you and your empire for good.”

A dark chuckle comes from Horde Prime, shaking Adora’s nerves. “Is something funny?” Adora asks.

“Adora, you are not going to use the weapon, or you would have already done so. You’d never risk the safety of your Catra.” He sneers at Catra’s name.

“You don’t know me, or what I'm capable of.” Adora spits back.

“Oh but I DO.” Prime growls. Standing up disconnects himself from the throne of tubes just before the power surges. The lights flickering, distracting Prime and leaving him looking very agitated. Looking back to Adora he narrows his gaze to her ear before snapping his fingers.

A high pitched sound shoots from the earpiece, causing Adora to instinctually flinch hard.

Then her earpiece shorts out, a simple spark before it falls to the floor rolling to Primes feet. Smashing it to bits, Prime bellows. “You miscalculated if you even began to think you could fool me. I see all. I know all!”

Glimmer, Bow, and Entrapta

Glimmer reconnects with the gang just before Entrapta trips something in the hacking process. The power flickers and the server room fills with electric hums of things powering back on.

“Hey Guys!” Glimmer huffs out. “We have got to hurry! “

“Entrapta!” Bow panics watching the lights. “What’s happening?”

“Not sure” Entrapta says, wiping the sweat from her brow while working on the servers. “It’s almost like there is an internal security measure forcing me out. It is infinitely more complex than anything I’ve ever encountered.”

The power surges again, for longer this time, and when it comes back up after a few seconds sparks start to bounce from the monitors and the connected machines. All of their earpieces make a static sound for just a moment before returning to normal. “Adora!” Bow worriedly tries to reach her but gets no response.

“Screw this!” Bow shouts. He sees more clones coming. “We don’t have any more time. We need to find Adora and get out of here!” Glimmer joins him. “We may not be able to hack him, but we can make him hurt!” She says while taking one of Bows grenade arrows from his quiver, placing it in Bows hand. “Let’s get out of here, and blow this place in the process.” Bow nods, and they all make way towards the door. Just before they leave, Bow lets the arrow fly, hitting its mark on the main server, causing a big explosion.

Catra

Catra creeps closer to the throne room. The whole ship is acting haywire. Overhead lights in the halls are flickering if not completely off, giving a new dimly lit atmosphere. A blessing because Catra has been able to hide in the shadows whenever clones come through the corridors. The clones that passed her, all in a hurry baring angry faces.

After some more time of carefully advancing within the shadows, Catra finally makes it to the dreaded throne doors. She can hear Prime speaking with someone, with the pistol in hand Catra cracks open the door to listen more clearly.

"I had thought the First Ones were all destroyed, vanquished. However, seeing your face is evidence that some fraction remains." Catra can see Prime circling Adora like prey while he speaks.

"That race of tyrants abandoned you on a forgotten planet. They made you their weapon, you know? Their She-Ra." Catra tightens her good hand around the pistol, holding it close to her chest. Her broken arm hands loosely.

Horde Prime stops pacing, and looks down at Adora. "You don't have to continue down their predestined path of destruction. So much needless waste, and pain. Give me She-Ra's loyalty, and I'll show you how much better the universe can be. A world of peace, with no end."

Catra carefully creeps forward, waiting for the opportunity.

"I don't fight for the First Ones.. I fight for my home, for myself, and for my friends. I'd never fight for you." Adora spits back,

remaining defiant. Horde Primes face tightens at the rejection. “For the last time, where is Catra?”

“Ah of course. Your Catra. She suffered greatly, clinging to the hope that you would come for her. With you staying true to your false hero heritage, all I had to do was wait.” He says while his scowl turns to a smirk. “As she would have said. You are so predictable.” Prime says smugly.

“Predict this..” Catra mutters. She stands, taking aim at Horde Prime. Before she can pull the trigger, a clone disarms her, and grabs by the back of the neck. She drops the gun on the platform and it scatters off the edge down into the blackness below. Catra yelps as she is lifted into the air by her neck.

“An eavesdropper Horde Prime.” The clone grasping Catra says announcing their presence.

“Well well well.. Adora look who came to join us.” Prime boasts.

Adora whirls around, the sight immediately bringing tears to her eyes.

Catra’s feet hang just above the ground, thrashing about as the clone holds her out on display. Catra has been stripped of her signature red uniform, and is wearing simple white shorts stained with blood. Her stomach is exposed showing multiple burns from all they had electrocuted her with the staff. Her top is a simple white sports bra like the ones issued back to them in the horde, also marked with blood around her ribcage.

Adora takes in her face next which is marred with cuts and dried blood. A gash on her cheek as well as her forehead. Her lip is split as well as one of her ears that is now folded over. Her mane is also gone, hacked off. Catra swings one arm wildly at the clone holding her. Adora notices her wrists are raw, and the other arm

hangs loosely while the other blindly claws at the clone holding her.

Adora bawls her fists, and her feet move on their own toward Catra, but finds herself restrained by more of Prime's clones.

"What have you done to her?!" The fury showing in her voice. Her eyes welling with tears.

"Nothing she didn't deserve." Prime looks to Adora before turning his attention to Catra and the clone holding her up. "She stands as a testament of what will happen to those who betray or stand in my way."

"Impeccable timing Catra." He starts. "Adora was just asking for you." Turning to the clone holding Catra. "Come forward brother, let us not deny our guest her request any longer."

The clone drags Catra forward, dropping her at Horde Prime's feet bringing a whimper from her. Prime smirks before looking at his clones. "Come brothers, im sure they have much to catching up to do. I'll be back when you are feeling more cooperative Adora." At that, the clones restraining Adora release her. Adora runs to Catra's crumpled form as they are left alone on the platform.

"Catra.. Look at me, I'm here" Adora coos, as she cradles Catras' beaten face. She carefully wipes some of the short locks from Catra's face, avoiding the slashes on her cheek and forehead.

"You… you came back.." Catra says meekly.

"Of course I would!" Adora closes her eyes and puts her forehead to Catra, and whispers "I'm not leaving you behind again.".

"Adora" Catra gasps. "You need to get out of here while you still can, he.." Catra starts before having a coughing fit. "He'll kill you

to get what he wants. He’s just toying with us now.”

“No Catra, I'm taking you home.” Adora’s eyes a mix of angry tears, looking down at Catra’s current state, and thinking about who caused her such harm. Catra nods letting silent tears fall.

The lights begin to flicker harshly, and the platform shakes. Unknowing to them, a large crack has formed at the other end. Slowly making its way to them.

“Can you stand? Come on, I got you.” Adora says standing and trying to help Catra to her feet by lifting her by the shoulders. Catra instantly cries out, causing an alarm to rise in Adora.

“My arm, I… I think they broke it.” Catra motions to her hurt shoulder. “I can’t move it.”

Adora's angry eyes meet Catra’s. “I swear, I will make him pay for everything.” Catra could see a fleeting glow about them. It vanished as soon as it came, but the familiarity was unmistakable.

“She-Ra?” Catra murmurs while Adora helps her to her feet.

“No, She-Ra’s gone.” Adora pulls Catra close, her good arm over Adora’s shoulders, having her lean into her as they begin to walk towards the exit.

“But I saw..” Catra starts, but suddenly another explosion goes off, and violent shaking of the platform throws them off balance falling

back to the floor. Adora lands hard and rolls a few feet away from Catra. Catra landing closer to the edge.

“Catra!” Adora yells out. She can hear a pained reply come from Catra, however her eyes are locked on a splitting crack in the floor, making it between them. Shattering the platform. The piece Catra is on separates from Adora's, dropping 10 feet. Its only tether to the base are a few flimsy steel rods sticking out from the side.

“CATRA.” Adora screams. “You have to get up, please. The platform.. Its’ falling!” Adora pleads over more distant explosions pleading for Catra to move. Catra remains frozen on the ground.

Adora moves anxiously thinking of what to do. If she were to jump to Catra, the section holding her would surely fall under both their weight. It was already teetering.

“Catra please!” Adora screams out. This time Catra stirs and makes eye contact with Adora. Adora feels a momentary relief as she sees Catra is still here, but the horror in Catra’s eyes shakes it away. Catra manages to stand on the unstable platform.

“You have to jump. I’ll catch you!” Adora sees Catra being hesitant when she reaches the edge.

“You promise?” Catra asks while looking down, unable to see the bottom of the dark abyss below them.

“I promise!” Adora yells back.

Unfortunately Catra never got the chance to jump. At the same moment Catra was gearing up for the jump, another splintering explosion happened behind Adora. Shaking the platform and causing the broken piece that Catra was standing on to fall.

"ADORA!" Catra's yell echoes up to Adora as she falls. Adora doesn't have to think twice about what she does next. She is either leaving here with Catra, or not at all.

So she jumps.

Chapter End Notes

Only one more Chapter for this, thank everyone that has left kudos, and comments! as always I crave constructive criticism. I want to learn how to write better, and this is my first ever fic. I've learned so much already thanks to yall.

Let's go home

Chapter Summary

> Adora finds the will to bring out She-Ra when she needs her most.

Chapter Notes

> Hello to everyone that has stayed with this story, and watched my writing go from tolerable, to maybe somewhat enjoyable. This story is basically over now, however I'm adding a bonus chapter where it's just Adora comforting and tending to Catra's injuries. Maybe setting up for other short stories that can follow.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Consciousness slowly returns to Adora. The ground is cold, hard, and disturbingly wet.. With a grunt she pushes herself up, her hands sliding in the dampness below her.

“Why is the ground wet?..” “Why am I on the ground?” Questions echo in her mind, followed by the rush of fractured memories. Flashes of Horde Prime’s ship swirl in her mind, followed by Catra with her mane shorn, arm twisted and clinging to a crumbling platform. The fall. Catra.

“Catra!” Adora’s voice cracks, her eyes darting around in search of Catra. She tries to stand, but a searing pain erupts from her knees, and falls back down to the wet ground. The wetness beneath her was her own blood, a dark pool spreading from her broken legs.

“Catra!” Adora screams again. With a pained groan, she turns and looks behind her, her gaze locking onto Catra’s body.

Rubble surrounds her. The outline of her body is highlighted by flickering sparks of exposed wires from the explosions. Catra is

laid out on her back, her head facing up. Her mouth is parted allowing a streak of blood that leaves a trail from her lips.

“Catra!” Adora pleads for her to move, staring intently at her for any sign of movement. There is none. Catra’s mouth remains frozen in a silent scream.

Ignoring the agonizing pain, Adora drags herself over to Catra, murmuring the whole way. “*No, no, no….please*.” Every inch of movement sends sharp jolts through her shattered knees.

When she reaches Catra, she pulls her close, cradling her broken body. “Catra.. It’s okay. I’m here. It’s going to be okay..” Her words are hollow, a poor attempt to deny and delay the truth. Adora is now facing her greatest fear.

Catra’s gone. Her mismatched eyes stare blankly and lifelessly up through Adora.

Catra’s lays limp and still in her hands. Adora weeps, drowning in grief. The physical pain of her broken legs diminished, the agony of her heart being shattered taking over. Gently she closes Catra's eyes, her fingers trembling against her eyelids. Adora lets loose a guttural scream that could echo throughout the entire ship. “Catra please!” Adora cries out. Desperately hoping for a miracle, that Catra might still be with her.

There is none.

Adora’s sobs eventually settle into soft, broken cries while she holds Catra. “I'm so, so sorry..” Adora whispers, with her forehead resting on Catra’s. “I should’ve come sooner.” Tears stream down

her face, falling on Catra's slashed cheek, which she tenderly wipes away. "I should've tried harder. I never should have stopped trying to bring you with me to Bright Moon."

A sad laugh escapes Adora's lips. "You would have hated it at first." She wipes her own face, stifling a sob. "But I think…. you could have grown to love living there… with me. It's all my fault for not convincing you sooner."

Adora tilts her head up, a choked cry escaping her lips. "I… I would have shown you all the reasons to stay." She peers back down unto Catra's face, her thumb gently caressing her cheek. "I know you would love the food, and the soft beds."

Adora doesn't question why she brings Catra's forehead to her lips, leaving only a breath of space between. "You deserve to know what that kind of comfort feels like." She murmurs into her. "Most importantly, I would have shown you we are more than just the soldiers that the Horde made us believe."

Adora closes the distance between her lips and Catra's forehead. There is a lingering taste of blood and sweat when she pulls away, but it doesn't matter. Adora can feel a cold rage begin to simmer, quickly becoming a burning fury that tightens in her throat. She will make Horde Prime pay. Even if it means her own destruction.

There is no pain, only a profound peace. Catra breathes easily. She doesn't know how, but she finds herself standing in endless darkness, her memory a blank slate. Unable to remember how she got here, or anything for that matter. This Catra is unmarred. Her hair is long. She is in her usual red and black uniform, complete with her matching headpiece.

It is impossible to tell where the floor ends and the wall begins. A seamless void of blackness envelopes her, yet a strange sense of comfort lingers in the air. A chill bites at her, and she shivers before rubbing both her arms for warmth. She scans the vast emptiness in front of her. She can see a small rectangle shaped light far off. “Where am I?” Catra wonders aloud. Even at this distance, the light gives off an irresistible warmth, a gentle urge pulling her in.

“Hello?” Catra calls out, her voice is hesitant. No answer comes, but the pull from the light intensifies, feeling an overwhelming draw guiding her closer. It feels.. right. And so, Catra begins the long silent walk towards the light.

Heavy interrupting footsteps snap Adora’s attention out of her mourning, forcing her back in the moment. She’s been cradling Catra’s head, her face buried into the cold curve of Catra’s neck while she cried. Her tears left stains behind in the soft fur when she looks up, finding a horde of hooded clones advancing. Gritting her teeth, “Stay back!” She snarls, her voice raw with fury.

The footsteps grew thunderous, and soon she found herself encircled by the clones. When the footsteps stop, Adora finds herself trapped in a cage of identical faces. Soon one steps closer, his voice breaking the silence.

“I am sorry for the needless waste Adora. None of this was necessary. All of this pain was preventable.” Adora can hear

Prime's voice laced with the clone speaking, and looks up at him. His eyes glowing a brighter green than the rest.

"You took her from me…" Adora whispers, her eyes shifting back down, and memorizing Catra's ravaged face, her fingers tangling in her short locks at the back of her head.

The clone's eyes narrow, then turn to Catra in her arms. "Some creatures are only destined for destruction." He says with a sigh. "End this senseless violence and spare your remaining allies from suffering a similar fate."

The Prime possessed clone gestures with his hands to the horde of clones around them. "It's over, Adora. It's truly unfortunate it had to end this way. However there is still time, align yourself and She-Ra with me, together we can usher in a new dawn for this universe."

"**You.. took.. her.. from.. me.**" She repeats, her voice low with a dangerous growl, each word drawn out. She can feel a newfound energy surging and igniting through her. Empowering her. Banishing the pain in her legs.

Adora's eyes blaze with fury, glaring into the clone's eyes, searching for the evil within. Prime himself. "**And I will destroy you for it.**" She spits.

A vortex, misty white energy surrounds the girls. Adora rises slowly in the center still cradling Catra in one arm. A tempest of wind gently whips Adora's golden hair around, but sends the nearest clones reeling back to the walls. The Prime possessed clone's eyes widen in fear and stumbles back.

"**FOR THE HONOR OF GRAYSKULL!!**" A blinding radiant light erupts from Adora's chest and takes over the entire room, blinding everyone.

Catra is only a few steps away from walking fully into this warm, calming light. She puts her hand in first. The feeling is instant. A gentle warm embrace wraps around her arm, coaxing her further into the light. She is ready fully give in, but stops short when she hears a muffled voice behind her. One she'd recognize anywhere, even now, when she can't remember anything.

"I'm so, so sorry.." Catra freezes in place, stopping herself from surrendering to the light. Her tail twitches in muscle memory at the sound of Adora's voice.

"Adora?" Catra whispers. She can see a dim blue light in the shape of a doorway flickering behind her just like the warm and welcoming light in front of her. Two paths. One choice.

"I think you could have grown to love living there… with me.." Adora's voice is unmistakable, and is perhaps the only thing that can break her out of the trance this light has her in. She turns away from the safety and the warmth the light promises to give, to follow Adora's voice.

"I would have shown you all the reasons to stay.." Catra winces at the grief and sadness in Adora's voice. Wherever Adora is, she's in pain. A sense of urgency returns to Catra as she picks up the pace. It doesn't matter what peace was behind that golden door.. Catra is only sure of one thing right now. If Adora isn't there, then it's not worth going to.

"You… took her from me." Adora's voice crawls out from the blue light ominously.

"Took who?! Adora please!" Catra pleads. She doesn't know what she's talking about, but it doesn't matter. Adora needs help. So she breaks into a run, moving faster toward the shrinking light. Only a sliver of light remains and she can almost touch it when she hears something that terrifies her to her core.

"And I will destroy you for it."

Even at a full sprint, she skids to a complete stop at those words. She's never heard Adora so angry, so full of raw rage. Countless thoughts swirl in her head on why Adora would say something like that to her. "Oh Adora, what did i do.."

Now hesitant, she looks back toward the other path she almost took, still inviting and warm, but she can't bring herself to take it. Catra takes her hands and runs them through her long mane. Closing her eyes, she desperately tries to remember what happened, and where she is, and what could cause Adora that much pain.

Flashes, pieces of painful memories and sounds invade her mind. Horde Primes ship. Being captured. Then there's Adora, and a crumbling platform. The fall... She should be dead. Realization comes over here as she looks at her uninjured body, then back to the bright light that beckons her to move on.

"Hang in there Adora." Catra whispers, turning away from the promise of peace, and shoves her claws into the sliver of blue light left in front of her, trying to pry it open enough to walk through. To get back to Adora.

“Come on… Just a little more!” Catra grunts. With a final surge, she forces the gap just wide enough for her shoulder, and plunges through sideways. The gateway vanishes just as she makes it in fully.

The light dissipates and where once Adora stood, now stands She-Ra. Extending a brilliant and radiant sword in her right hand. Catra’s body is still being held firm in her left hand. She looks down at her and for a fleeting moment, a flicker of hope ignites. She could swear that Catra just released a weak sigh.. “Maybe there is still time.” She thinks and hopes. A desperate prayer.

Wasting no time, she gently puts Catra on her shoulder, then unleashes a devastating swing from her blade toward the clones still standing. A blast emits from the sword like a wave, knocking them all prone.

She-Ra turns to the clones lying scattered on the ground. There is a sea of grunts and groans coming from all of them. She begins searching for the one whose eyes are brighter, the one who Prime is actively seeing through. She has a message she intends to deliver.

It doesn’t take her long, and she walks over standing above him. “You miscalculated.” Her voice was unwavering. “It’s far from over for me. However, this is the beginning of the end for you.” Then with a swift strike, she ends the clone’s existence, killing Prime’s connection.

Bow, Glimmer, and Entrapta

The trio are racing down the corridors, being chased by dozens of clones. Bow manages to keep the distance with a flurry of arrows as Glimmer and Entrapta sprint ahead. Another violent explosion startles them, and rocks the ship, sending tremors through the hall they are in. The corridor crumbles in on itself, trapping them between a dead end and the onslaught of clones behind them.

“What do we do?! We’re cornered!” Gimmer cries out, looking hopelessly around for another exit. “I don’t know!” Bow shouts while letting another arrow fly, taking out another clone. He reaches back to his quiver for another arrow, his heart sinking. “I'm running out of arrows!”

Entrapta speaks up, her fingers twirling around each other. “I, uh, may have an idea.” Both Bow and Glimmer exchange a look, waiting for her to finish. “But… you have to promis..” Entrapra begins.

“Spit it out!!” Bow interrupts her before she can finish, urgently knocking his last arrow.

“Well, it may or may not involve upgrades, that also may or may not include me completely disregarding every time you told me to stop tinkering with Darla.” Entrapa admits in a rush.

“Entrapta, if you get us out of here, you can do whatever you want with the ship!” He says while letting the arrow fly, hitting another clone right in the chest.

Squealing with pleasure, Entrapta puts her fingers to her mouth for a loud and sharp whistle. A few seconds pass where nothing happens, before suddenly the hall is shaking. Distant rumbles and crashes can be heard and grow closer before the ship bursts through the hall, taking out the remaining clones. Both Bow and Glimmer's mouths are open in shock as Darla lowers her bay doors for entry.

“Uh okay then.” Bow starts. “Now we just need to find Adora and get out of here.” He says while looking up at the ship still in shock watching the dust settle from the crumbling wall.

“I don’t think we will have to look far…” Entrapta says from behind Bow and Glimmer, her voice nervous and shaky. “What do you mean..” Bow starts but stops after turning around and seeing She-Ra striding down a pile of rubble.

“She-Ra… She's back..” Bow stammers, then his eyes drop to the figure She-Ra is holding. A body, or the shell of what’s left of one. Their head is turned inward toward She-Ra’s chest. Short choppy hair, matted with blood, hides their face. Their whole body is riddled with cuts and burns. Underneath the blood and grime, he can see their shoulders and arms have a similar striped marking that he's seen before..

“Is that Catra…” Glimmer whispers, her hand flying to her mouth, just as Bow makes the connection for himself. His stomach churns, the nausea felt in his throat, unable to shake the thought of how easily that could have been Glimmer instead.

She-Ra walks toward the group, carrying Catra’s limp body bridal style. Glimmer can’t keep the tears back when seeing the state of Catra. “What happened? Is.. Is she..” Glimmer can’t bring herself to ask if Catra is still alive.

“There’s no time. We need to get out of here.” She-Ra says while walking past them into the ship. She lays Catra’s body down softly on the floor inside Darla, before rushing to the command center.

With her hand on the scanner Darla springs to life.

“Welcome She-Ra.” Darla chirps out.

“Darla, get us out of here, and make it quick.” She-Ra commands as the bay doors close behind Glimmer, Bow, and Entrapta. Darla then navigates a swift and explosive escape, leaving behind a gaping hole in Prime's mothership.

She-Ra returns to Catra, finding her friends kneeling around her. Glimmer is crying into Bow’s shoulder. Glimmer looks up as She-Ra gets closer. “… she’s not breathing.”

Entrapta has wrapped herself up in her hair looking away, unable to watch the tense situation.

“I'm sorry Adora…” Bow starts. “She’s gone.”

“No.” Adora says forcefully. She sits down next to Catra, and pulls her close. “I'm not giving up on her.” She pulls her face in, and their foreheads pressed together. “Come on Catra.. You’re not done, not yet. Not when we are so close to going home.”

A golden energy engulfs them. A warm and healing aura emits from She-Ra passing over Catra. Bow and Glimmer exchange worried glances while Entrapta remains turned away. Adora pours all of She-Ra’s power into Catra, reverting back to Adora after draining herself.

A heavy and agonizing silence stretches amongst the gang. Catra remains still and lifeless. Then, with a sudden gasp, Catra launches forward, drawing a ragged breath in Adora’s arms. She coughs before steading herself.

Catra looks up and finds Adora’s tear streaked face. “He..Hey Adora.” Catra’s words are weak, but she still manages a smile. She

leans her head into Adora’s chest. Adora pulls her in tight, hugging her while tears spill freely.

“Oh Catra. We’re going home.” Adora murmurs. Her voice filled with relief that their story didn’t end, and can still have hope for tomorrow.

Chapter End Notes

> Stay tuned for the bonus chapter if you want. As always comments and criticism is appreciated and deeply craved.

Reclaiming Herself

Chapter Summary

Catra wakes up in the ship, Adora is there waiting for her.

also had most of this written for a minute and just finished the part that was taking me too long, so I'm posting it before i change my mind on it.

Chapter Notes

I tried to use past tense in the beginning, then switch to present tense when Catra wakes. If it comes across weird then i apologize.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

While She-Ra's transformation had healed Adora of all her injuries, the healing gift seemed to have exhausted itself bringing Catra back. Her arm was still visibly broken and her body still bore the marks of Primes cruelty. Riddled with burns from the electricity the stun staffs exerted on her.

Catra had only regained consciousness briefly once She-Ra revived her. Adora felt a low broken purr that faded into silence as Catra went unconscious.

Bow then took charge, advocating that they needed to at least try to bandage Catra up some, and get her somewhere to rest. Adora, overcome with a mix of worry and relief, agreed and didn't waste any time.

That was nearly 2 days ago.

Catra had remained in a deep sleep, fueling the increasing worries and anxieties inside Adora. She had watched Catra's chest rise and fall, looking for the slightest change. Lack of sleep had Adora over analyzing the sounds she could hear from Catra.

Bow and Entrapta had quickly transformed one of the rooms in the ship to a makeshift medical bay utilizing Mara's surprisingly well-stocked supplies of medicine, gauze and ointments. The only thing she didn't have was fluids. Which is what Catra desperately needed. She lost a dangerous amount of blood. Their only choice was to keep Catra comfortable while her body recovered.

Adora has made a habit of calling out for Bow and Entrapta, always in a panic, whenever she thought Catra needed help. The two would run in immediately, never being too far away. Bow would always go to Adora asking questions trying to figure out what happened. Entrapta would go straight to her gadgets, checking Catra's vitals.

Each time the results were the same. Catra was just fine, actually she was improving. Color had returned to her cheeks, her breathing seemed more and more less pained as time went on. The last time Adora called for them, Entrapta went to Adora with her gadgets, attempting to measure her vitals instead.

"What are you doing!" Adora snapped, shoving Entrapta away.

"Adora…" Bow began softly.

"I think Catra stopped breathing for a second. Please check on her!" Adora's eyes are a little bloodshot, and there are dark half circles under her eyes.

"Adora." Bow said, more firmly this time. "Catra is okay. She needs rest. We are worried about you." Adora, taken aback, scans the faces of her friends, her gaze ending on Glimmer leaning in the doorway.

“You’re scaring me Adora, please just let Entrapta make sure you’re okay.” Gimmer pleaded. Adora wanted to fight it, but sighed and nodded her head back to Entrapta, letting her get close to check her vitals.

Entrapta administered a few tests, humming the entire time to herself. Adora is frustrated they are wasting time on her, when Catra is right there.

Finally, Entrapta chirped out. “It is as I suspected!” Grinning to herself for being right.

“And what would that be?” Adora asked defensively, snapping at Entrapta.

Entrapta, completely unfazed, began rattling off. “Your heart rate is highly elevated, your blood pressure is a little high, that combined with the obvious signs of irritability..

“That's enough, Entrapta.” Bow interjected gently. “Thank you.”

“Adora.” Bow turns back to her, placing a hand on her bouncing knee, stilling her. “You are sleep deprived. Staying awake this long is hurting yourself.”

“I don’t care!” Adora snapped again. She looks back at Catra's sleeping face, then dropped her shoulders. “I need to be here when she wakes up. She’ll freak out if she doesn’t know where she is. I… I want to make sure she knows she is okay.” She turned to Bow. “What if she doesn’t remember how she got here? That she’s safe now?”

Glimmer left from the doorway, approaching Adora and placed a hand on her shoulder. “Adora, if that’s what you’re worried about, then we can handle it.” She had given Adora a gentle smile when

she finally met her eyes. “I promise we will not leave Catra’s side while you sleep. One of us will be here.”

Adora hated to admit it, but she was tired. So very tired. So instead of fighting with them she nodded.

“It’s settled then. Ill take the first watch.” Bow had volunteered. “Glimmer, would you help Adora to bed. Make sure she actually makes it there.”

“Of course.” Glimmer squeezed her shoulder, nudging her up, and away from Catra.

‘And Adora..’ Bow waited until Adora looked back at him from the doorway before finishing. “She will be okay.” Offering her a smile. Adora smiled back. “I know.”

A warm and gentle weight is resting on her legs. Not heavy enough to cause any pain, but enough to anchor her in place. Catra stirs, her eyelids flutter slowly trying to open them. The blurriness is overwhelming, and she tries to lift her arm to wipe her eyes when she feels a sharp throb in her shoulder halting her movement. She lets out a small groan as her vision begins to clear.

Her movements startle Adora, who was sitting in a chair at the end of Catra’s bed. She had been leaning over, with her head on Catra’s legs lost in thought.

“Hey! You’re awake! Take it easy.” Adora coos with relief.

“Adora?” Catra's voice is a little raspy as she watches the hazy figure shift closer to her.

“Yes Catra. It's me.” Adora says with a genuine smile that illuminates her face as Catra’s vision clears, letting her see the relief and smile on Adora’s face.

“Why are you looking at me like that?” Catra asks before looking down at herself, and can see why her arm was restrained moments before. There’s a sling around it.

“Do you remember how you got here?” Adora asks softly, ignoring Catra’s previous question, grabbing her good hand.

Catra turns her head, watching Adora’s hand in hers, her thumb rubbing gentle circles over Catra’s hand. She looks back up to Adora’s face, she is watching her so intently, so patiently. “I'm sure it had something to do with you.” Catra huffs out a little arrogantly

“I'm serious Catra… Do you remember anything that happened?” Adora presses again.

“Uh yeah.. Yeah I do, I remember everything I think.” Catra winces at the memories.

“Oh, okay. Um, are you in pain? Entrapta said that you have some broken ribs, but luckily your lungs were not punctured. So we, uh, I wrapped them the best I could.” Adora says while looking over Catra with the same look as before.

Catra glances down at her chest for the first time, realizing that only bandages cover her chest, wrapped tightly around her body, keeping the fractured ribs from moving too much. “Yeah, a little but its fine. My shoulder feels really sore too.” she says. A wave of embarrassment runs over her thinking about Adora wrapping her bare chest, tending to her while she wasn’t conscious.

"It was the only thing we could think to do, without a doctor. Also Entrapta says your arm isn't broken, just dislocated. Bow helped her get it back in, but I doubt the soreness will go away quickly." Adora's eyes widen remembering something. "Here!" Adora says while turning around to a table at her side. When she turns back she has some pills and a glass of water. "Take these, they will help with the swelling and pain."

Catra eyes the medicine for a few seconds before sitting herself up, and holds her hand out.

"Careful!" Adora says at Catra's sudden movement to sit up, but Catra just rolls her eyes while taking the pills. She puts them in her mouth, then reaches for the glass of water Adora is holding. She takes a sip, to help swallow the pills. After the first swallow, she realizes how thirsty she was, quickly downing the glass.

Catra returns the empty glass back to Adora, finding that she is still staring at her with the same look as before. Almost like Adora was looking at her for the first time, taking her all in but on a deeper level that she couldn't decipher.

"Seriously Adora, why are you looking at me like that?" She says again, a hint of annoyance laced with her words.

Adora sighs and rubs the back of her neck, looking away to avoid Catra's gaze. Almost losing Catra made her realize a few things about herself, and her deep feelings for Catra, but now isn't the time to have that talk with Catra.

"I almost lost you back there, actually I did for a moment, so it's a miracle you're here right now, can you just let me enjoy this? You being here." Adora asks sincerely.

Catra doesn’t know what she was expecting Adora to say, but it definitely wasn’t that. So she just laughs it off. “You are such an Idiot.” But can’t help the smirk that curls up as she says it. Her smile quickly fades as she looks back down at herself. Her arms and legs still have some grime and dry blood on them, and feels an overwhelming need to take a shower. To cleanse her mind as well as her body from that place.

“I know.” Adora says with a smile to Catra's previous taunt. Breaking Catra out of her thoughts. Looking back up at Adora she notices a tear beading on Adora’s lower eyelid. “Adora.. You're Not crying are you?” She says hesitantly.

Adora stands and faces away from Catra, discreetly wiping away her eyes. “Im just so.. So glad that you’re okay.” Adora says with her back still to Catra.

“Rigghhtt” Catra draws out, a little suspicious, but doesn’t push. “Do you think I can take a shower or something? I don’t know if I can stomach seeing myself like this..” Catra asks.

“Are you sure that you are up for it? You just woke up.. Maybe I should go get Entrapta and see what she thinks.” Adora says turning back to face her

“**No!**” Catra quickly huffs out, followed by a short pause. “I’m fine. *Please*?”

“Okay.” Adora says simply. “Ill go set one up. I’ll be back soon.”

Some time later, Adora returns and finds Catra softly snoring. A smile tugs on her lips as she approaches the bed and sits next to Catra's sleeping form. The movement stirs Catra, and she opens her eyes looking up to see Adora staring down at her.

"If you're still tired then the shower can wait." Adora says softly. "The ship doesn't have a lot of hot water at a time, but I went to make sure Bow didn't use it all again, since you insisted on one.."

"No, it's fine." Catra says with a yawn. "Thanks Adora." Catra sits up and motions her legs off the bed, instantly feeling a head rush from the sudden movement.

"Whoa.." Catra says, steading herself with one hand, the other arm held tight in the sling.

"Hey slow down!" Adora says, placing her hand on Catra's shoulder. "Your body is still weak."

"No kidding.." Catra mumbles out.

"Here." Adora offers her arm. "The washroom isn't too far down the hall, let me help."

"Okay." Catra takes her arm and stands up, together they make their way across the room, but stopping abruptly when Catra hesitates.

"Hey.. Something wrong?" Adora says, sensing Catra's unease.

"Uh, I don't think I'm ready to see the others yet.." Catra whispers, as if the others could hear her through the door.

"Oh. Well they are gathered on the other side of the ship going over some of the findings that Entrapta pulled from the server

room. Turns out she thinks we actually got something worth looking into."

Catra doesn't say anything but simply nods, and lets Adora lead her out.

True to her word, Adora and Catra didn't run into any of the others on their way to the shower. Once inside, Catra takes a look around, there's a fresh towel on the counter. There's a chair in the corner, with Catra's signature red and black clothes.

"Okay, so there's a towel here, with some fresh clothes there in the chair. And there's soap in the shower. I won't go too far, so just yell if you need anything." Adora intended to stay propped up in the hall just in case Catra were to fall or need her for anything, but wanted Catra to feel a sense of privacy if she wanted it.

Catra has found the mirror and is just looking intently at herself. A deep scabbed over cut runs along her cheek, and she's sure it will scar. Her short hair still matted in places with dry blood, but her right ear made her stop. She lifts her hand up to feel it, the ear is spilt, and already scabbed up. Two pieces instead of one.

"*Stay*." Catra's voice cutting Adora's thoughts off.

"Stay?" Adora repeats.

"Yeah, if that's okay. I'd feel better knowing you're here." Vulnerability showing through in Catra's voice.

“Of course.” Adora then moves the clothes off the chair to sit, while Catra slips in the shower, pulling the curtain closed behind her. Luckily there is a ledge she can sit on, and she pulls off her dirty bottoms tossing them over the curtain. The same ones she was left in while Primes prisoner.

She pulls the sling off her arm, and it does feel better, for a moment. Though without the support from the sling, her shoulder begins to ache. Then goes to undo her chest wraps. None of it is graceful, since she only has one good arm right now, but eventually she finds herself bare. Her ribs are very sore to the touch.

Turning on the shower, the hot water cascades over and down her back washing away the grime and if she’s lucky the memories with it. Catra watches the water run from clear to the color of rust, then slowly back to clear. She shivers as she watches the evidence of the dried blood go down the drain. Small tufts of fur also wash down the drain. Singed and burnt, from the stun staffs used on her, leaving blistering skin behind. Her now short hair hangs in front of her as she hangs her head beneath the shower.

As she slowly washes her hair, she thinks about what Adora said earlier. “You said Entrapta found something useful? Like to use it against Prime?” Catra says through the sound of water falling around her.

“Yeah, they didn’t get much, but she was able to see some redacted information stored away deep in the files. We think it’s related to a planet nearby, something he’s trying to hide.”

Catra hums along, her eyes closed feeling the warmth of the water on her neck. “Sounds important..”

“We think so too.” Adora adds, and there is a pause before she continues. “We actually set a course for there last night. If there's something there that can take down Prime, and stop him from ever hurting someone else, then I want to go.” Adora says more seriously.

A long silence stretches out after that, only broken by the sound of water.

Soon Catra finishes and turns off the water. Adora can hear a few heavy breaths before Catra speaks. “Me too.”

“What?” Adora asks, confused.

“I want to go too.” Catra clarifies.

“Then we will.” Adora says noticing the water has stopped. “Want me to hand you the towel now?” Adora asks in a lighter tone.

“Yeah, that would be great.” Catra huffs out.

Catra can hear her footsteps just behind the curtain, and watches as a hand pokes through with a large towel. Catra snatches it without a word, but can somehow feel the smirk that Adora has afterward as she hears Adora step back away from the curtain.

“Adora?” Catra asks tentatively after a while.

“Yes Catra?” Adora responds from her spot leaning on the sink.

“I think I need help out.” Catra says through heavy breathing. Adora walks up to the curtain, her hand on the edge pulling it back slowly.

Catra looks exhausted and is panting, like this took more energy from Catra then she anticipated. Catra is sitting on the ledge in the shower wrapped in the towel. Guilt swarms in her stomach. She should have made her stay in bed longer.

"If you tell anyone I asked for help I'll deny it." Catra laughs, but Adora knows she is just trying to mask her embarrassment.

"Wouldn't dream of it." Adora says with a wink, hoping to ease Catra's nerves. Stepping closer she extends her hand. "I got you."

"*I know.*" Catra whispers, those words tugging at something deep inside Adora. She helps Catra to the chair outside the shower, and watches as Catra catches her breath.

"I think I'll be okay now." Catra says feeling less light headed. "Ill meet outside when I'm done." She says letting Adora know she can handle drying and dressing herself.

"Alright, I'll be right outside if you need anything." Catra watches Adora leave the washroom then starts to finish drying off.

After almost a painstakingly long hour. Catra emerges from the washroom. She is wearing her signature red and black clothes, with her short hair tussled and still damp. She has the sling back on, but otherwise is looking much better and more like herself.

Adora stands up from leaning on the wall ready to walk back with her. "I think Glimmer made some food, are you hungry?"

Catra's stomach rumbles before she can answer for herself. Both of them giggle at that.

"Thought so. How about we go join the others." Adora holds out her hand and Catra takes it.

“I know they’ll be happy to see you.” Adora adds, easing Catra’s anxiety with a smile.

“Okay.” Catra says. “Let's go.”

Chapter End Notes

So I left this open ended to see if there is any want or interest to seeing this version of Catra and Adora in another story. Possible slow burn where they find melog and make it back to Etheria. Let me know?

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!